

TCG Speed Shipper Growth Plan: \$25 → \$100 → \$1k MRR

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Where we are today

We make **\$29.93 gross / \$26.96 net MRR** from 7 subscriptions, and growth so far has come from search, not outreach.

Metric	Today	Note
Paying customers	7 (4 Premium, 3 Base)	50% of all accounts pay
Gross MRR	\$29.93	$4 \times \$5.99 + 3 \times \1.99
Net MRR after Stripe	\$26.96	Stripe takes 18% of a \$1.99 charge, 8% of \$5.99
Blended ARPU	\$4.28 / month	Premium is 80% of revenue
Signups, last 7 days	5	11 in the last 30 days
Labels printed this month	456	One Premium user printed 330 of them
Organic rank, "tcgplayer shipping labels"	#6	No paid ads on that search at all
Cold partnership emails sent	~100	0 human replies, 8 bounces: stopped

What the data says:

- People who find us through search convert well, since half of all accounts pay. The problem is traffic, not the product.
- A tiny paid user base means one power user (330 labels) is most of the usage. Losing them would hurt. Keep them happy.
- Base at \$1.99 is expensive to collect: Stripe keeps 36¢ of every \$1.99.

- The funnel is now measured. Anonymous counts for visits, CSV loads, downloads, signups, checkouts and upgrades by traffic source live on the Admin → Overview page from the next deploy. **Every decision below should be checked against it.**

The math

\$100 MRR needs about 20 paying customers; \$1k needs about 140, and only if average revenue per customer rises from \$4.28 to about \$7. At today's prices, \$1k would take 234 customers, which is a much harder climb.

Goal	Paying customers at \$4.28 ARPU	At ~\$7 ARPU (after pricing changes)	New visitors needed*
\$100 MRR	24 (+17)	15 (+8)	~1,700
\$1,000 MRR	234 (+227)	143 (+136)	~14,000 + replacing churn

*Assumes about 1% of visitors eventually pay: roughly 3% sign up and about a third of those upgrade. Replace this with the real rate from the admin funnel after 30 days of data.

Churn matters at \$1k. At an assumed 6% monthly churn, 143 customers lose about 9 a month. That means 9 new paying customers every month just to stay flat. Annual plans and a sticky feature set are what keep that number low.

How ARPU gets from \$4.28 to ~\$7 (details in Phase 2):

- Base \$1.99 → \$2.99 for new customers, with existing customers keeping \$1.99.
- Annual plans (2 months free) that lock in revenue and cut Stripe's fixed fee to one charge a year.
- A Pro tier around \$12.99 for high-volume sellers like our 330-labels-a-month user.

Phase 1: \$25 → \$100 MRR (next 60 days)

Goal: 20+ paying customers by November 25, from about 1,700 visitors. Cheap, fast channels first; paid ads only as a measured test.

Week 1: unblock everything

- ☐ **Link Netlify to GitHub** (Site configuration → Build & deploy → Link repository → `main`). The new site, envelope formats, Shipping Plan and analytics aren't live until this happens.
- ☐ **Connect Google Search Console** and submit `sitemap.xml` . It shows which searches already bring people in.
- ☐ **Buy a real domain** (e.g. tcgspeedshipper.com, about \$12/yr) and point it at Netlify. A `.netlify.app` address looks like a side project in ads and on Reddit.
- ☐ Send the "what's new" draft to paying customers (it's in Gmail drafts).
- ☐ Ask Rob (330 labels/mo) for a one-line testimonial and put it on the homepage.

Weeks 2-4: show up where sellers already are

Google's results for our keywords are YouTube, TikTok and Reddit, not websites. That's where to be.

- ☐ **Record 3 short videos** (30-60s, vertical): "TCGplayer CSV → 50 labels in 10 seconds", "Print PWE envelopes from TCGplayer", "Which orders need tracking?". Post them to YouTube Shorts, TikTok and Instagram under the Clujkeeps name, and link them from the Whatnot and eBay profiles.
- ☐ **One genuinely useful Reddit post a week** in r/mtgfinance, r/PokemonTCG, r/yugioh and r/lorcana (read each sub's self-promo rules first). Lead with the free PWE guide or shipping-rules post, and mention the tool as the maker, openly.
- ☐ Join 3-5 TCG seller Discords and Facebook groups. Answer shipping questions and link the guide, not the pricing page.
- ☐ **Start the Google Ads test** (section below): \$5/day, US only, exact-match seller keywords.

Weeks 5-8: conversion and word of mouth

- ☐ **Make the referral two-sided:** the new user also gets something (e.g. first month of Base free). Today only the referrer is rewarded, which is why there are 0 referrals.
- ☐ Add a "share with a seller friend" prompt after a successful download, the moment people are happiest.
- ☐ Improve the free-limit paywall. When someone hits 10 labels, show what their batch would cost on Base (\$1.99) and let them upgrade in one click.

- ☐ Pitch 10 **small** creators (1k–50k subs) who make “how I ship” videos, e.g. the channels ranking for “tcgplayer shipping labels” today. Offer the 30% affiliate deal. Every email carries a mailing address and an opt-out line.

Check at day 30 and day 60 on the admin funnel: which source produced paying customers? Put the next month’s time into that source.

Phase 2: \$100 → \$1k MRR (months 3–12)

Reaching \$1k takes three things together: higher prices per customer, a bigger addressable market than TCGplayer alone, and one feature that makes the tool part of every shipping day.

1. Pricing (month 3)

Plan	Today	Proposed	Why
Free	10 labels/mo	10 labels/mo	Keeps the top of the funnel open
Base	\$1.99/mo, 500 labels	\$2.99/mo or \$29/yr	Stripe’s cut falls from 18% to 13%; still cheaper than one PWE mistake
Premium	\$5.99/mo	\$5.99/mo or \$59/yr	Annual locks in the year and cuts churn
Pro (new)	—	\$12.99/mo	High-volume sellers: postage tools, order history, multiple return addresses/stores

Existing subscribers keep their price (grandfathered). Raise prices for new signups only, and say so in the announcement.

2. Product bets, in order

- TCGplayer tracking upload file.** Sellers paste tracking numbers today and copy them in one by one. TCGplayer supports importing shipping info by file, so generate that file from the pasted numbers. It saves every paid user time on every shipping day. Small build, high stickiness.
- More marketplaces.** The same sellers also ship eBay, Whatnot, Mercari and Shopify orders. Accept those CSV exports so it becomes “the card seller’s shipping tool”, not just TCGplayer’s. That roughly triples the market.

3. **Buy postage in-app (Pro).** Integrate a postage API (EasyPost or Shippo) so tracked labels and tracked-envelope postage are bought and printed here. Competitors already offer tracked-PWE labels, and this is the biggest reason to pay \$12.99.
4. **Order history and reprints** across sessions for signed-in users. It fits Pro and reduces churn.

3. Channels at scale

- **SEO:** grow from 21 to ~50 pages (one useful post a week). Search looks like today's main source of signups (outreach produced none), and it compounds for free.
- **Creator affiliates:** 5–10 active partners at 30% revenue share. This is the only channel that scales without your time.
- **Google Ads:** scale only the ad groups whose cost per paying customer is under \$15 (see below).
- **In-product growth:** two-sided referrals plus a small "Printed with TCG Speed Shipper" line on free-plan packing slips, which already exists. Every free shipment advertises to another collector.

Milestones: \$250 MRR by month 4 · \$500 by month 7 · \$1,000 by month 12.

Google Ads plan

Run a \$150, 30-day test on exact seller searches. Scale only if a paying customer costs under \$15. Net revenue per customer is about \$4.30/month; at an assumed 7-month lifetime that's ~\$30. Spending more than \$15 to win one isn't worth it.

Good news: a live check of "tcgplayer shipping labels" found **zero ads** on the page, so clicks should be cheap. **Catch:** these searches are too small for Google's keyword planner to report volume, so expect a few clicks a day, not hundreds. Broad terms like "shipping label generator" cost ~\$8/click and bring the wrong people, so skip them.

Setup

Setting	Value
Campaign type	Search only (turn off Display and Search Partners)
Location	United States: "presence", not "interest"
Budget	\$5/day for 30 days (\$150 total)

Setting	Value
Bidding	Manual CPC, \$1.00 max to start; after 50 clicks, Maximize Clicks with a \$1.25 cap
Auto-tagging	ON (default). Our admin funnel reads the <code>gclid</code> and counts these visits as <code>google_ads</code>
Devices	All; desktop +20% (people print from computers)
Landing page	Homepage (new hero) for ad groups 1-2; the matching blog post for group 3

Ad groups and keywords (exact [] and phrase " " match only)

Ad group	Keywords	Land on
1. Labels	[tcgplayer shipping labels], "print tcgplayer labels", "tcgplayer label printer", "tcgplayer packing slip", "tcgplayer csv", "tcgplayer shipping label template"	/
2. Envelopes / PWE	"pwe shipping cards", "print envelopes trading cards", "trading card envelope labels", "avery labels trading cards", "ship cards in envelope"	/
3. Seller how-to (cheap, lower intent)	"how to ship cards on tcgplayer", "tcgplayer shipping guidelines", "tcgplayer shipping requirements"	/blog/tcgplayer-shipping-guidelines.html

Negative keywords (campaign level): buyer, order status, where is my order, track my order, how long does, delivery, refund, customer service, login, coupon, promo code, free shipping code, jobs, careers, price, prices, value, buylist, sell my cards, near me, ups store, usps store, stamps, label maker machine, brother, dymo tape, wedding, invitation, greeting card, christmas card, 5x7, 4x6 cards.

Ad copy (one responsive search ad per group, all within Google's limits)

Headlines (≤30 chars): TCGplayer Labels in Seconds · Free TCGplayer Label Tool · Upload CSV, Print Labels · 4x6, Envelopes & Avery 5160 · 10 Free Labels Every Month · No Retyping Addresses · Built by a TCGplayer Seller · Packing Slips Included · See Which Orders Need Tracking · Print PWE Envelopes Fast · Rollo, MUNBYN & Dymo Ready · Plans From \$1.99/Month · Your Data Stays in Browser · Try It Free, No Account

Descriptions (≤90 chars):

1. Turn your TCGplayer order export into print-ready labels, envelopes & slips in seconds.
2. Free for 10 labels a month. No account, no install. Paid plans from \$1.99/mo.
3. Flags orders that need tracking or signature, then prints just the ones you pick.
4. Made by a card seller. Your buyers' addresses never leave your browser.

Trademark note: TCGplayer can ask Google to block its name in other advertisers' ad text. If ads get limited for that, swap in "TCG Seller Label Tool" / "Card Seller Label Tool".

Measuring it

Use **Admin → Overview → Funnel**, row `google_ads` : visits → CSV loaded → PDFs → signups → checkouts → upgrades. This needs no Google tag and no cookies, so the site stays consent-free.

If you later want Google's automated bidding, add the Google Ads conversion tag. It sets cookies, so at that point turn on Cookiebot (the hook is already built; paste the ID into `public/js/site.js`) with Consent Mode.

Decision rules

After	If	Then
50 ad clicks	Under 15% of ad visitors load a CSV	Keywords are pulling the wrong people: tighten to exact match, add negatives
50 ad clicks	15%+ load a CSV	Landing works; keep going
\$150 spent	0 upgrades	Pause ads; move the money to creator affiliates
\$150 spent	Cost per paying customer ≤ \$15	Raise to \$10-15/day, add ad groups for eBay/Whatnot sellers

After	If	Then
Any time	A keyword spends \$20 with no CSV loads	Pause that keyword

Also check for a Google Ads new-advertiser credit offer when you open the account.

Channel playbook

Rank by cost to reach a seller who ships weekly: SEO and short videos first, creators second, ads third, cold email never.

Channel	Weekly effort	Cost	What to do	Measured by
SEO / blog	2 hrs	\$0	1 post a week on a real seller question (e.g. "tcgplayer shipping not confirmed", "ship graded cards"); refresh old posts with the new features	google row in funnel; Search Console clicks
Short video	1-2 hrs	\$0	Screen-record the CSV → labels flow; post natively to YouTube Shorts / TikTok / Reels; pin the link	youtube , tiktok rows
Reddit / Discord / FB groups	1 hr	\$0	Answer shipping questions with the guides; one useful post a week per sub, maker disclosed	reddit , discord , facebook rows

Channel	Weekly effort	Cost	What to do	Measured by
Creator affiliates	1 hr	30% of revenue they bring	Small "how I ship" creators; admin → Affiliates creates their link + dashboard	affiliate row + Affiliates tab
Referrals (two-sided)	0 after build	1 free month each	Prompt after a successful download	referral row
Google Ads	15 min	\$5/day test	See plan above	google_ads row
Customer email	30 min/month	\$0	Monthly "what's new" to paying users; win-back to dormant free users (needs mailing address + opt-out)	Upgrades that week
Cold email to shops	—	—	Stopped. ~100 sent, 0 replies, 8 bounces, and it hurts Gmail's sender reputation	—

UTM links: add `?utm_source=youtube` (or `tiktok`, `reddit`, `discord`, `email`) to every link you post. The funnel then credits each channel correctly, even when a site hides the referrer.

Weekly scorecard (every Monday, 10 minutes, from /admin)

One question each week: which source produced paying customers, and did we put more time there?

Number	Where in /admin	Phase 1 target	Phase 2 target
MRR	Overview → MRR (live from Stripe)	\$100 by Nov 25	\$1,000 by month 12
Paying customers	Overview → Paying	20+	140+

Number	Where in /admin	Phase 1 target	Phase 2 target
Visits / week	Funnel → Visits	200+	1,500+
Visit → CSV loaded	Funnel step 2	25%+	30%+
CSV → PDF downloaded	Funnel step 3	70%+	75%+
Signups / week	Overview → Users	5+	25+
Checkout → upgrade	Funnel steps 5→6	60%+	70%+
Monthly churn	Stripe cancellations ÷ paying	< 8%	< 5%
Errors (7 days)	Overview → Errors	0 unexplained	0 unexplained

If visits rise but CSV loads don't, the traffic is wrong: fix the channel. If CSV loads rise but upgrades don't, the pricing or paywall is wrong: fix the product.

Risks and what not to do

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
TCGplayer changes its CSV export	The tool stops working overnight	Parser tests cover the known formats; errors now appear in /admin within minutes
Deploys are manual	Fixes sit unshipped (they did this week)	Link Netlify to GitHub so every merge deploys
One power user is most usage	Losing them hurts revenue and word of mouth	Personal check-ins; Pro tier built around their needs
Price change backlash	Existing customers feel squeezed	Grandfather current subscribers; announce clearly
Trademark in ads	TCGplayer can restrict its name in ad text	Keep generic fallback headlines ready
Spam complaints	Gmail reputation drops, customer emails land in spam	No more cold email; every marketing email gets a mailing address + opt-out

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Adding tracking pixels	Needs a consent banner and can scare privacy-minded sellers	Stay with the built-in cookie-free funnel unless ads prove out

Don't: buy broad keywords ("shipping label maker"), pay for ads before the funnel has a week of data, cold-email hobby shops, cut the Free plan (it's the top of the funnel), or spread effort across every channel at once. Pick the two that the funnel shows working and double down.